

Enquiry Capture & Response

An n8n pipeline that turns a website enquiry form into a tracked, regionally-routed sales lead — validated, scored, logged, and answered automatically.

n8n

Google Sheets

Gmail

1 Executive Summary

Website enquiry forms are a mess in practice: different plugins name fields differently, spam bots fill in honeypot fields, and leads land with no consistent record of ownership or urgency. This workflow solves all three problems in one pass — it recognizes fields by shape as well as name, rejects anything that looks like spam or is missing essentials, and guarantees the lead is safely logged to a spreadsheet before any email is even attempted, so a failed send can never lose a lead.

2 Key Metrics

Trigger	A single webhook accepting POST submissions from any WordPress form plugin
Form Compatibility	Contact Form 7, WPForms, Gravity Forms, Elementor, Fluent Forms, and unrecognized forms
Spam Filtering	Honeypot check, email format validation, and an “effectively empty form” check
Routing	Regional owner assigned by matching the longest postcode prefix, with a safe fallback
Priority Scoring	Rule-based Low / Normal / High / Urgent score from company, phone, detail and urgency signals
Data Safety	The lead is written to Google Sheets before any email is attempted, every time
Send Safety	Three modes — preview (log only), test (redirect to one inbox), live

5+

FORM PLUGINS SUPPORTED

3

SEND SAFETY MODES

100%

LEADS LOGGED BEFORE EMAIL

3 Business Value

- ✓ **Works with whatever form plugin is already on the site** — no need to standardize on one form builder or rebuild existing pages.
- ✓ **Spam and junk filtered automatically** — honeypot fields, invalid emails and empty submissions are rejected before they reach a human.
- ✓ **No lead ever silently lost** — the sheet is written before any email is attempted, so a Gmail hiccup can never mean a lead vanishes.
- ✓ **Safe to test before going live** — preview and test modes let the whole pipeline be verified without risking a live customer inbox.

4 Architecture Overview

One continuous pipeline from webhook to website response, built around a central configuration node.

STAGE	RUNS	PURPOSE
Capture & Standardise	On form submission	Maps plugin field names into one clean object; detects spam or incomplete data
Route & Score	After validation	Assigns a regional owner by postcode and calculates a Low–Urgent priority score
Compose & Log	Before any email	Builds customer and owner emails, then writes the enquiry to Sheets first
Safety Gate & Send	Per configured mode	Preview, test or live decides whether emails actually go out, and to whom

5 How It Works

Capture & Standardise

- 1 A webhook accepts the site's POST request; a config node loads sheet ID, routing rules and branding.
- 2 Common field patterns are recognized across five major form plugins, with shape-detection as a fallback.
- 3 A filled honeypot, invalid email, or empty submission is rejected before reaching the tracker.
- 4 The exact rejection reason is kept visible in the execution output for debugging.

Route, Score & Log

- 1 The postcode is matched against regional prefixes, longest prefix first, with a safe fallback owner.
- 2 A transparent rule-based score (Low–Urgent) is calculated with its contributing reasons attached.
- 3 Branded customer and owner emails are composed, then logged to Sheets before anything is sent.
- 4 A safety gate (preview / test / live) decides whether email goes out, then a stable JSON response returns to the site.

6 Reliability & Security Design

- ◆ **Sheet written before any email** — a Gmail failure can never mean a lead is lost, only that a notification is delayed.
- ◆ **Three-mode send safety** — preview, test and live are controlled by one configuration flag, avoiding accidental live-sends.
- ◆ **Graceful missing-owner handling** — a region with no configured owner email still logs the lead rather than failing the run.
- ◆ **Transparent spam & scoring logic** — both the rejection reason and the score's contributing factors stay on the item.
- ◆ **Resilient email sends** — customer and owner email nodes continue the workflow even if the send itself fails.
- ◆ **Multi-plugin tolerant** — unrecognized forms still get through cleanly via shape-based field detection.

7 Setup Checklist

- ☒ Add the Google Sheet ID and confirm the Enquiries tab's header row matches the column configuration.
- ☒ Replace the sample regional owners, postcode prefixes and company details in the configuration node.
- ☒ Connect Google Sheets and Gmail credentials on the relevant nodes.
- ☒ Keep TEST_RUN = true with a real test address for your first tests.
- ☒ Submit three test cases — valid, invalid email, honeypot filled — then switch to live.

8 Node-by-Node Map

Capture & Configure	When Cleaning Enquiry Arrives → Configure Enquiry Pipeline → Parse Form Fields
Spam Gate	Check If Real Enquiry → Handle Spam or Incomplete
Route & Score	Assign Enquiry Owner → Score Enquiry Priority
Compose & Log	Compose First Reply → Prepare Sheet Row → Append Enquiry to Sheets
Send & Respond	Check Sending Condition → Send Reply to Customer → Notify Owner via Email → Build Website Response

SUMMARY

Designed and built end-to-end in n8n, demonstrating multi-plugin form parsing, rule-based lead scoring, region-based routing, and a log-before-send data safety pattern.